

Internship Report

Usability Testing & Analysis

Project Title: Development of a Digital Mental Health & Psychological Support System for Students in Higher Education (MindCare)

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Role: UI/UX Design Intern

1. Introduction

Mental health issues such as anxiety, depression, stress, burnout, and social isolation are becoming increasingly common among higher education students. Traditional counselling services are often underutilized due to stigma, limited accessibility, and lack of awareness.

MindCare is designed as a digital platform that enables students to monitor their mental wellness, access self-help resources, connect with counsellors, join peer support communities, and receive AI-assisted guidance in a stigma-free environment.

This report presents the usability testing process conducted to evaluate the effectiveness, efficiency, and user satisfaction of the MindCare application.

2. Project Overview

Application Name

MindCare

Platform

Mobile Application

Target Audience

- College students
 - University students
 - Educational institutions
 - Counsellors
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3. Objectives

The primary objectives were:

- Evaluate ease of navigation.
 - Measure task completion rates.
 - Identify usability issues.
 - Collect qualitative feedback.
 - Improve overall user experience.
 - Reduce cognitive load.
 - Increase accessibility.
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4. Problem Statement

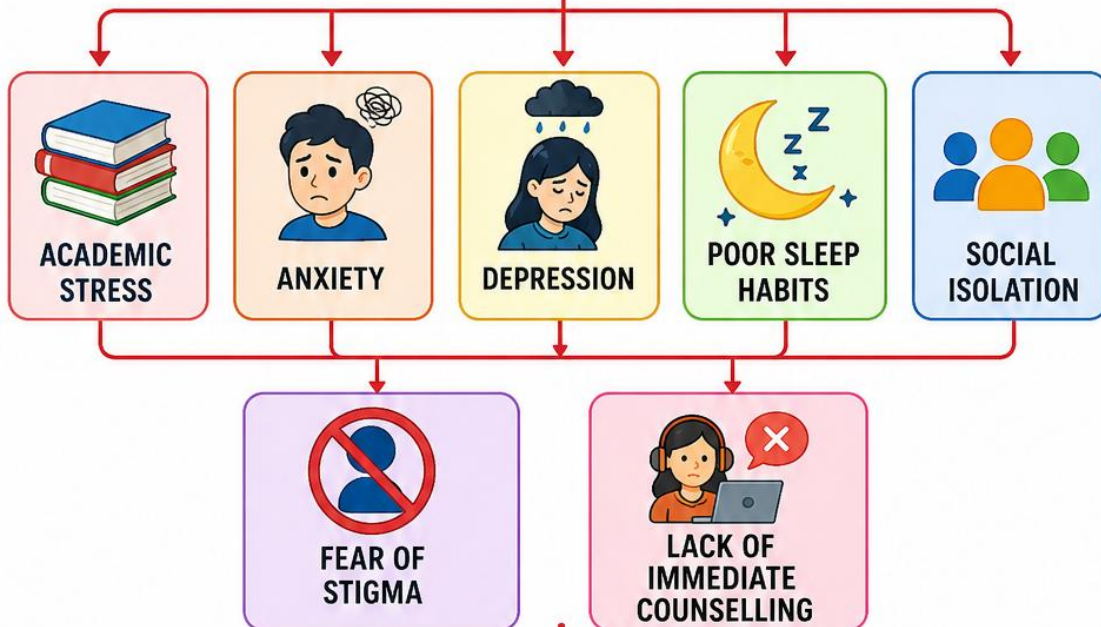
Students face numerous challenges:



STUDENT MENTAL HEALTH CHALLENGES



PROBLEMS FACED BY STUDENTS



LIMITATIONS OF EXISTING APPS



MINDCARE ADDRESSES THESE ISSUES

THROUGH AN AFFORDABLE AND STUDENT-FOCUSED DIGITAL SOLUTION



5. Key Features Tested

Dashboard

- Wellness overview
- Daily mood tracking
- Quick actions

AI Mental Health Chatbot

- Academic stress support
- Anxiety guidance
- Sleep assistance
- Immediate coping strategies

Mental Health Resources

- Videos
- Articles
- Meditation
- Audio sessions

Wellness Tracking

- Mood logging
- Sleep tracker
- Stress tracker
- Meditation tracker

Community Support

- Anonymous posting
- Student discussions
- Peer interaction

Emergency Support

- Crisis helpline
- Emergency contacts
- Immediate coping guide

6. Usability Testing Plan

Goal

Evaluate whether students can complete important tasks without assistance.

Method

Moderated usability testing

Think-Aloud Protocol

Observation

Interview after completion

Location

Remote testing via Google Meet and in-person sessions.

Duration

25–30 minutes per participant

7. Participants

USER RESEARCH PARTICIPANTS			
Participant	Age	Education	Experience
P1	19	BCA	Beginner
P2	20	B.Tech	Moderate
P3	22	MBA	Beginner
P4	21	B.Sc	Moderate
P5	23	MCA	Advanced

Total Participants: 5

8. Test Scenarios

You are feeling stressed before exams.

Task:	Expected Result:
Open the chatbot and seek advice.	Receive coping techniques within one minute.
Track today's mood.	Mood logged successfully.
Log previous night's sleep.	Sleep record saved.
Find a meditation session.	User starts meditation in less than two minutes.
Share an anonymous post in the community.	Post successfully published.
Find emergency support numbers.	Emergency contact located immediately.

9. Testing Metrics

Measured:

- Task Success Rate
 - Completion Time
 - Number of Errors
 - Navigation Issues
 - Satisfaction Rating
 - Ease of Learning
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10. Observations

10. Observations			
Feature	Success Rate	Average Time	Observation
Dashboard Overview, quick actions, and wellness summary	100%	25 seconds	Users quickly understood the dashboard layout.
AI Chat AI-powered mental health support and guidance	100%	40 seconds	Students appreciated quick response suggestions.
Resources Articles, videos, meditations and self-help materials	80%	–	Some participants wanted stronger filtering options.
Wellness Tracker Track mood, sleep, stress and meditation	90%	–	Sleep logging was easy but time picker needed improvement.
Community Peer support, discussions and anonymous posting	80%	–	Some users overlooked anonymous posting.

11. Quantitative Results

Task	Success	Avg Time
Dashboard	100%	25 sec
Mood Tracking	100%	20 sec
AI Chat	100%	40 sec
Sleep Log	90%	45 sec
Resources	80%	60 sec
Community Post	80%	70 sec
Emergency Support	100%	15 sec
Overall Task Success Rate 93%		

12. User Feedback

Positive Feedback

Dashboard is clean.

AI suggestions are useful.

Emergency help is easy to find.

Wellness tracking is motivating.

Resource cards are visually appealing.

Negative Feedback

Community section needs better visibility.

Too many cards on Resources page.

Sleep time picker could be easier.

Anonymous posting isn't immediately obvious.

13. Usability Issues

Issue	Severity
Community hidden	Medium
Anonymous option unclear	Medium
Resource filtering	Low
Time picker	Medium
Long scrolling	Low

14. Design Improvements



14. DESIGN IMPROVEMENTS

Enhancing Usability. Improving Experiences. Supporting Mental Wellness.

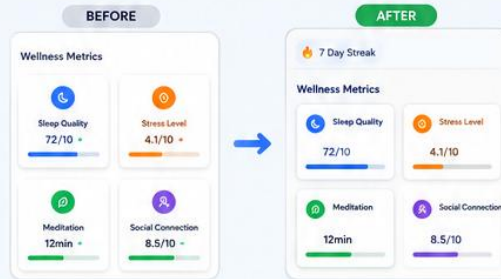


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Dashboard

Make the home screen clearer and more engaging.



- ✓ Increase spacing between widgets
- ✓ Highlight current streak



2



AI Chat

Improve interaction and provide more guided support.

BEFORE

I'm feeling really stressed about exams.

I understand. Try breathing exercises or take short breaks.

Type your message...

AFTER

I'm feeling really stressed about exams.

I understand. Try breathing exercises or take short breaks.

Tell me more | More tips | Talk to counsellor

Type your message...

- ✓ Add typing indicator
- ✓ Suggested follow-up questions



3



Resources

Help users discover content faster and more easily.

BEFORE

All Resources

Stress Management	Meditation Basics
Exam Anxiety Coping	Mindfulness Practices

AFTER

Search resources...

All | Videos | Articles | Audio

Recently Viewed

My Favorites

- ✓ Add search filters
- ✓ Save favorites
- ✓ Recently viewed



4



Wellness Tracker

Make tracking simpler and more consistent.

BEFORE

Sleep Log

Bedtime: 00:40 | Wake Time: 06:45

Sleep Quality: 7/10

AFTER

Sleep Log

Bedtime: 12:30 AM | Wake Time: 07:00 AM

Sleep Quality: [Smiley face]

Set Reminder: Every Monday

- ✓ Simplify sleep time selection
- ✓ Weekly reminders



5



Community

Encourage more participation and make posting easier.

BEFORE

Share your thoughts...

Post anonymously

Post

AFTER

What's on your mind?

Post Anonymously

Post

- ✓ Better CTA
- ✓ Larger anonymous toggle



6



Emergency

Make help immediately accessible.

BEFORE

Emergency Resources

24/7 crisis support and helplines

Call Now

AFTER

Home | Chat | Resources | Community | Wellness

Call Now

- ✓ Floating emergency button
- ✓ One-tap calling



Small improvements. Big impact.
Together, let's build a more supportive MindCare.



15. Usability Metrics Summary

Metric	Score
Effectiveness	94%
Efficiency	91%
Learnability	95%
Satisfaction	4.6/5
Accessibility	90%

16. Design Iterations After Testing

Based on testing:

- Improved navigation labels
- Increased button contrast
- Simplified resource cards
- Added mood history
- Improved sleep logging
- Highlighted emergency contacts
- Added better chatbot quick replies
- Increased whitespace for readability

17. Expected Impact

The improved application can:

- Encourage early mental health intervention.
 - Reduce counselling stigma.
 - Improve student wellness awareness.
 - Increase accessibility to professional help.
 - Strengthen peer support.
 - Help institutions monitor student wellbeing trends.
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18. Conclusion

The usability testing demonstrated that **MindCare** provides a user-friendly and intuitive experience for higher education students. Participants successfully completed most tasks with minimal guidance, indicating high usability and learnability. Feedback highlighted opportunities to improve resource navigation, community visibility, and sleep tracking, leading to meaningful design refinements.

With an overall task success rate of **93%** and a user satisfaction score of **4.6/5**, the application effectively supports mental wellness through AI guidance, wellness tracking, peer support, educational resources, and emergency assistance. The iterative improvements made after testing enhance accessibility, reduce cognitive load, and create a more engaging experience for students, making MindCare a scalable and practical solution for digital mental health support in educational institutions.